

Convert your Android device into a complete Linux desktop computer

Here's a project that can be a complete delight for open source lovers. Zac Powell has developed a Complete Linux Installer App, which allows users to install Linux on their Android devices alongside the Android operating system. The project has been launched as a new Indiegogo campaign to turn your Android device into a full Linux desktop computer.



In its current form, the app allows users to install some of the popular distributions including Ubuntu, Debian and Fedora on Android devices. After that, you can boot Linux as an app. Once your favourite open source desktop is booted, you can connect to the desktop via VNC. You can also do that by switching away from the Linux window and starting a VNC Android app. But in order to do all this, the Android device needs to be rooted.

This project aims to improve the convergence between a mobile device and a desktop by providing a better Complete Linux Installer to work with a Linux desktop over HDMI or on the device's screen. That's not all. Users can access the storage of both operating systems. The app also offers some other integration features including the ability to play audio from Linux via the device's speakers. Users can also view the Android notifications from within Linux. Zac is also working to enable sending emails and text messages from within Linux via accounts set up in Android.

window size. This ensures that spacing, etc, is always maintained and the user experience isn't hampered by uneven margins and excessive white spaces. For the previews, Nautilus now uses the window along with a back button. The earlier quick look pop-up has been dropped.

Google Maps can now be embedded onto websites

Google has reportedly added the option for users to embed its Google Maps application onto websites. According to reports, the overhauled design, which the search giant had introduced in May 2013, can now be added to websites. The company had been working on Maps and had fixed a number of issues users had faced. These included adding new features and shortcuts to the Maps function, which is quite popular all over the world.

The search giant had apparently first made a beta launch for the embedded maps, but has now opened it to the public. Currently, embedded Maps can be used by anyone who wants to use it. The embedded version will reportedly work in almost the same manner as the usual Google Maps website. In addition, it will remember the locations that the user has stored.

Gmail for Android updated

The Gmail app for Android has reportedly been updated. It can be downloaded from the Google Play store. Google has added a number of new features to the app. These include downloading Zip files from Gmail, vacation responders, enhanced attachment functionality and the ability to print directly from your smartphone through cloud printing.

The vacation responder is the newest feature available in the app. This allows the user to set an automated mail while on vacation. This mail becomes an automatic response to whoever sends you a mail during this period, a feature that is ideal for professionals on vacation and without an Internet connection.

Cloud printing support in the app, though, is confined to KitKat devices. The Gmail 4.7 app allows users to print their email messages directly from their smartphone using the cloud printing option. Users can either select a single message or more than one message from their threads.



Dell's new network operating system is based on Linux

Dell has a new Linux-based network operating system. According to reports, the Dell Networking N-series has a Linux-based operating system and a hardware chassis built of silicon. The system also has two new switches in the N2000 and the N3000, which are both 1 GbE switches that have 10 GbE uplinks. Dell is in a very competitive market, with others like HP, Cisco and Juniper.

These two switches have the 24- and 48-port configurations, and while the former operates as a Layer 2 device, the latter is a Layer 3 device. In the Enterprise Networking Planet, Arpit Joshipura, VP at Dell Networking, says, "We took all the features that are relevant to the campus LAN and ported data centre FTOS features as well."

The Linux-based operating system that operates Dell's networking systems is known as the Force 10 operating system (FTOS). According to Joshipura, "The kernel is Linux, but that doesn't show up from an operations perspective. What it provides is the openness, reliability and programmability that Linux brings."

Dell is reportedly also going to revamp its C-Series switches, which it got along with the Force 10 acquisition.